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The Real Estate Associates: A Land and Housing Developer of the 1870s in San Francisco

ANNE BLOOMFIELD San Francisco

FROM THE ACQUISITION of California by the United States in 1846 until the great earthquake and fire of 1906, San Francisco grew from a sleepy town of fewer than 500 inhabitants to a proud metropolis of 350,000.¹ This growth created a 60-year-long housing boom which, as in other cities such as New York and Boston,² slowed only during depressions. Almost nothing has been known about the builders. This article reviews work and circumstances of the most productive builder from the middle period of these 60 years, The Real Estate Associates.

Before the boom, about 250 houses “of all descriptions” were scattered thinly about the townsite, most of heavy frame construction, some of adobe. Those who stayed in San Francisco during the gold rush instead of going to the diggings were too busy making money from the transients to pay much attention to their own shelter. “Whole streets are built up in a week and whole blocks swept away in an hour . . . a large portion of the fixed inhabitants live in tents and places which cannot be described with any accuracy.”³ Since all were intent on making money quickly, wives and families were left behind, the hotel or boarding house became a way of life, and the market for family housing—such

as the rows then going up in New York, Boston, and Philadelphia—was minimal.⁴

Speculation in vacant land flowered in San Francisco, aided by surveying efforts that established rectangular grids. The first survey, made in 1839 during the Mexican possession of California, laid out a few blocks, not quite aligned to north, measured in Spanish varas (1 vara = 2.75 feet). Each block contained six lots of 50 varas each, or 137½ feet to a side, making blocks 275 x 412½ feet. In 1847, another survey continued this pattern, locating Market Street at a diagonal to the other streets and on the route to the old Franciscan Mission church. The 1849 survey both extended the 50-vara blocks and created new 100-vara blocks south of Market, each four times the size of the former. Speculators were soon dividing 50- and 100-vara lots into smaller parcels of various sizes; later builders of mass housing followed their example.⁵

San Francisco’s first speculative housing tract was erected early in 1850. The previous November, merchant William

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1. Gladys Hansen, *San Francisco Almanac, Everything You Want to Know about The City*, San Francisco, 1975, 10.

2. Charts of house construction in Charles Lockwood, *Bricks and Brownstone, the New York Row House 1783-1929*, New York, 1972, 77, 254; Bainbridge Bunting, *Houses of Boston’s Back Bay: An Architectural History, 1840-1917*, Cambridge, MA, 1967, 5; Sam B. Warner, Jr., *Streetcar Suburbs: The Process of Growth in Boston 1870-1900*, New York, 1973, 44.

3. Parker, *San Francisco Directory, 1852-1853*, San Francisco, 1852, 6-7; Harold Kirker, *California’s Architectural Frontier: Style and Tradition in the Nineteenth Century*, Santa Barbara and Salt Lake City, 1973, 26-28; Charles P. Kimball, *San Francisco Directory*, San Francisco, 1 September 1850, 3.

4. Langley, *San Francisco Directory*, indicates in 1861, p. 15, 340 hotels and boarding houses, and on p. 53 in 1868 614 boarding houses; B. E. Lloyd, *Lights and Shades in San Francisco*, San Francisco, 1876, 450-451; Eastern mass housing seems to have been almost entirely row houses, see Charles Lockwood, *Manhattan Moves Uptown: An Illustrated History*, Boston, 1976; *idem*, *Bricks and Brownstone*; Sarah Bradford Landau, “The Row Houses of New York’s West Side,” *JSAH*, xxxiv, March 1975, 19-36; Bunting, *Houses of Boston’s Back Bay*; Warner, *Streetcar Suburbs*; *idem*, *The Private City: Philadelphia in Three Periods of Its Growth*, Philadelphia, 1968; William John Murtagh, “The Philadelphia Row House,” *JSAH*, xiv, December 1957, 8-13; T. Kaori Kitao, “Philadelphia Row House, Is It Peculiarly American, or Even Uniquely Philadelphian?,” *Swarthmore College Bulletin*, LXXIV, April 1977, 6-11; Kenneth Ames, “Robert Mills and the Philadelphia Row House,” *JSAH*, xxvii, May 1968, 140-146. The *Avery Index to Architectural Periodicals*, Boston, 1973, xii, 531-533, lists 19th-century articles on row houses in Chicago, IL; Omaha, NE; Newark, NJ; Hartford, CT; St. Louis, MO; St. Paul, MN; Yonkers, NY; and in Arlington, Brookline, Roxbury, and Somerville, MA.

5. Hansen, *San Francisco Almanac*, 130; Paul W. Gates, “Carpetbaggers Join the Rush for California Land,” *California Historical Quarterly*, lvi, Summer 1977, 98-127.



Fig. 1. San Francisco, northeast portion, showing improvements through 1867-1868, U.S. Coast Survey, 1869 (California Historical Society).

Howard had received a consignment of 25 prefabricated houses shipped from Boston. They were clapboard with peaked roofs and Gothic trim. Howard set most of them up south of Market Street a good half mile away from the main settlement.⁶

Even farther away was the best-known early housing tract, South Park, a speculation of pioneer industrialist and businessman George Gordon. "Tract" is hardly the word for these elegant, two- and three-story houses built of stuccoed brick. Gordon planned his development for the elite, included fire ordinances and zoning restrictions, and carved an oval park out of the center of the 100-vara block. With George H. Goddard as architect, the first 17 houses went up during the winter of 1854-1855, completing one-fourth of the intended London-style crescents. Gordon's plan succeeded in that South Park did become the city's "center of fashion" in the 1850s and 1860s. But the unimproved lots

sold slowly, so that less than half the intended development was built.⁷

Most other early San Francisco developments were like those of the Mount Vernon Proprietors on Beacon Hill in Boston or John Jacob Astor in New York: the speculators acquired land, laid out streets, subdivided and sold lots for houses.⁸ The Hayes Tract, for example, was a 160-acre square two miles west of the then city hall. Thomas Hayes, County Clerk from 1853 to 1856, very likely arranged some

7. Albert Shumate, *The California of George Gordon*, Glendale, CA, 1976, 119-139; Kirker, *California's Architectural Frontier*, 68-69, pl. 21.

8. In the first half of the 19th century a syndicate called the Mount Vernon Proprietors bought land on what is now called Beacon Hill, leveled it, laid out streets, and sold house lots, building a few houses as stimulation for further development. See Bunting, *Houses of Boston's Back Bay*, 27-28; Allen Chamberlain, *Beacon Hill: Its Ancient Pastures and Early Mansions*, Boston and New York, 1925, 26, 44, 61-62, 92-93, 161-162, 187-189. In the same period, John Jacob Astor frequently bought large tracts on Manhattan, well north of the developed area. He would wait some years, lay out streets, and sell house lots at fantastic profits. See Lockwood, *Manhattan Moves Uptown*, 57-58, 68; Christopher Tunnard and Henry Hope Reed, *American Skyline*, Boston, 1956, 67-68.

6. Kirker, *California's Architectural Frontier*, 39-40; Parker, *San Francisco Directory*, 1852-1853, 13.

deal with Mayor T. C. Van Ness. In 1859, Hayes commenced construction of a railway from the main city through the sand hills where Market Street was supposed to be, and out beyond his tract. Van Ness accepted a block from Hayes and built his residence facing the wide avenue which bears his name. Hayes himself lived on the next block north. He reserved nearly two blocks in the western part of the tract for the Hayes Park Pavilion, a public pleasure grounds served by a spur of his Market Street Railway. In 1859, the remainder of the land was offered at public auction in 27½-foot lots, but not many purchasers came forward. Housing was slow to develop so far out from the business district (Fig. 1).⁹

Hayes may have offered his lots just a bit too soon. The population growth which alone could support such far-flung speculation was recorded in the censuses as: 35,000 in 1852, 57,000 in 1860, 149,000 in 1870, 234,000 in 1880, 299,000 in 1890, and 343,000 in 1900.¹⁰ However pattern-setting the gold rush may have been, the 1860s and 1870s witnessed the greatest increases in San Francisco's population during the 19th century, creating the greatest pressure for new housing.

Each *San Francisco Directory* of these two decades boasted about the increases in new buildings erected since the previous *Directory* (Fig. 2). It can be assumed that almost all the brick buildings listed were for downtown businesses, since wooden buildings were forbidden in a 30-block area at center city since 1853. Wood was preferred for housing because it was assumed to be safer in earthquakes and to promote a healthy living environment. Moreover, it was inexpensive, could be easily ornamented, and assured low insurance rates due to a well-organized fire department. Even discounting for editors' boastfulness and for claim shanties and factory buildings, a considerable number of wooden residences were erected, a reflection of population increases and economic cycles.¹¹

9. Letter by Frank McCoppin of 1894 quoted in Edgar M. Kahn, *Cable Car Days in San Francisco*, reprint, Oakland, CA, 1976, 10-13; H. A. Cobb, *Great Peremptory Sale of 1000 Homestead Lots in the Hayes Valley Tract . . . on Saturday, June 11, 1859*, San Francisco, 1859, 14 pp.; *Map of the Hayes Tract*, San Francisco, "April 1861" in pencil; Edward A. Morphy, "San Francisco's Thoroughfares," *San Francisco Chronicle*, 30 June 1918, 7 July 1918, 14 July 1918, California Historical Society Scrapbook, IV, 12-18; Langley, *San Francisco Directory*, 1860, *passim*.

10. Figures rounded off from Hansen, *San Francisco Almanac*, 10.

11. Le Count and Strong, *San Francisco Directory*, 1854, 214; Langley, *San Francisco Directory*, 1860, 21; 1861, 19; 1862, 21; 1863, 6; 1864, 10; 1865, 4; 1867, 15; 1868, 3, 19; 1869, 21; 1871, 25-26; 1872, 3, 18; 1875, 3, 14-15; 1876, 3, 13; 1877, 3, 11; 1878, 3, 11; 1879, 11; Bishop, *Directory of San Francisco*, 1875, 11-12; Lewis Publishing Co., *The Bay of San Francisco*, Chicago, 1892, 278. In the 19th century, economic cycles in California differed from those in the East. The Civil War had very little effect in California, and the panic and depression of 1873 were not felt until the late 1870s.

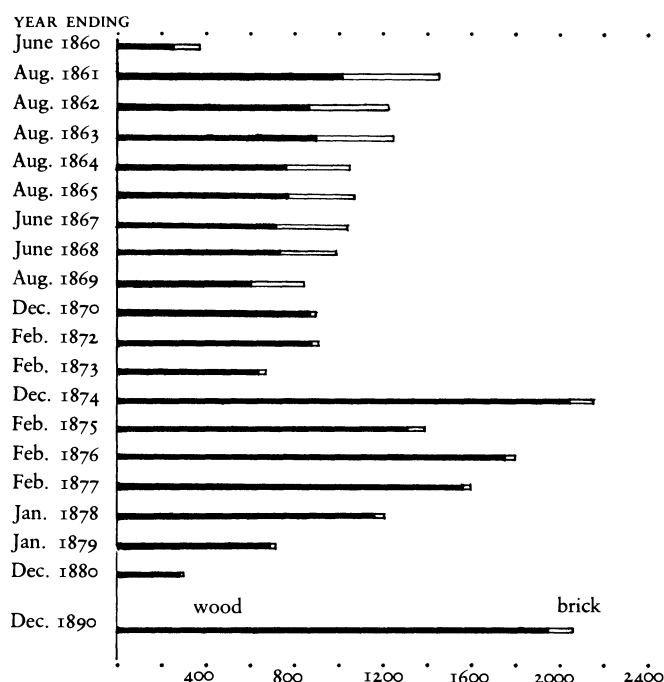


Fig. 2. Number of buildings erected in San Francisco, 1860-1880, 1890, *Directories* and *Bay of San Francisco* as in fn. 11 (author).

The wooden residences of the 1860s were modest affairs, many of them "cottages," or one-story dwellings. In 1861 Judge H. C. Hastings had "a number" of four-room cottages built south of Market, and made a profit renting them at \$10 a month. Others followed his example. The 1861 *Directory* remarked upon "the celerity with which long rows of houses spring up."¹² Advertisements mention rows of four or five houses.¹³ A 1912 observer remembered "nothing statistically startling or architecturally exceptional during the decade."¹⁴ Otherwise little is known about the houses of the 1860s. As the city grew, cottages were replaced by larger structures; moreover, the area where most of them were located (Fig. 1) was destroyed by the fire of 1906. Those single houses that remain exhibit the lag in house fashion, compared to the East Coast, which Baird and Kirker discuss.¹⁵ Most are in a chaste Italianate style. The flat façade

California alone experienced a depression following the completion of the transcontinental railroad in 1869.

12. Langley, *San Francisco Directory*, 1861, 16.

13. *San Francisco Daily Morning Call*, 5 December 1861, 3; 12 September 1868, 2, 3; 15 January 1869, 4.

14. John P. Young, *San Francisco: A History of the Pacific Coast Metropolis*, San Francisco, 1912, 411.

15. Joseph Armstrong Baird, Jr., in *Times Wondrous Changes: San Francisco Architecture, 1776-1915*, San Francisco, 1962, x, 16-20, says Italianate was common in the United States from 1850 to 1860, but in San Francisco from 1850 to 1880. Kirker's major thesis in *California's Architectural Frontier*, vii-ix, 26-27, 64-66, 91, is that in typically colonial fashion, California architecture copied that of the immigrants' homes and therefore lagged stylistically up to a generation behind them.

has three window or door openings on each floor, siding is laid horizontally, the roof is expressed in a gable or concealed behind a decorative cornice.

Additional houses were produced by the popular "homestead associations." About 170 of these corporations were formed in the 1860s in order to turn a profit by breaking up large landholdings and encouraging house-lot ownership among workingmen. The "health" and "advantages" of this system were well publicized. The officers would buy a piece of land outside the settled area. Membership was usually bought with an initial fee or deposit of \$10 to \$100 and monthly payments of \$10. When the appropriate sum was collected, the member received title to a lot. Some then built houses.¹⁶

By 1870, a new type of development, speculative building, had come into its own. The *Directory* of December 1869 reported that architects Johnston & Mooser were putting up a block of eight three-story frame houses (across from today's Hilton Hotel), and that a builder was offering six two-story houses six blocks to the west. The next summer, 24 cottages served by horse cars were being sold on a block not far from the old Mission church. The first well-known example of speculative building was put up during the summer and fall of 1870 by David Farquharson (1827-1914), architect of the Bank of California, with the fashionable jeweler J. W. Tucker apparently providing financial backing. Later known as "Tuckerville," the development covered one Western Addition block with 40 semidetached, bay-windowed cottages, of which only 2209 Jackson remains. Like the homestead association lots, these were sold for a down payment, the remainder to be met in monthly installments with interest. A newly opened extension of a horse car line ran within a block of the property.¹⁷

Another new extension of the same line ran near the first development of the firm discussed in this article, The Real Estate Associates (T.R.E.A.). Companies such as Rondel's Homesteads, and individuals like Henry T. Hinkel, were buying 50-vara and larger lots and putting up several houses on each; but T.R.E.A.'s more than 1,000 houses erected during the 1870s¹⁸ stood unchallenged for a decade. In 1875,

the company claimed to have built more detached houses than any other person or company in the United States in a similar time span. Its work includes familiar rows of detached, nearly identical, Italianate houses such as those on Clay Street facing Alta Plaza Park (Fig. 3), in the 100 block of Guerrero Street, and on Bush Street between Fillmore and Cottage Row.¹⁹

The houses were located for the most part on sand outside the already built up area (Fig. 1) and well beyond the business district, but near street railway lines (Fig. 4).²⁰ Such land could be bought cheaply. T.R.E.A. purchased tracts sometimes by the 50-vara lot, sometimes by the whole block, and then subdivided them into appropriately sized lots. It pioneered quality housing in the Mission and Western Addition, two areas immediately west and southwest of the thickly inhabited area. Many T.R.E.A. houses still stand (see Appendix) and have continued in use as residences.

Typically, the company would build a group of virtually identical, detached houses (Figs. 3, 6, and 7), all with the same setback and equally tall, forming long horizontal lines of cornices and door hoods or marching up a hill in equal

The three main sources disagree. "Real Estate Associates' New Building," *The Resources of California*, San Francisco, April 1877, 1, obviously a publicity article but containing accurate financial data, gives the largest numbers for the years it cites, 1873-1876, a total of 1,057 houses. Next most expansive and also intended as publicity is material in "The Progress of the City" sections of Langley, *San Francisco Directory*, 1871, 23; 1873, 25-26; 1875, 15; 1876, 13; Bishop, 1877, 40; 1878, 41-42). These give a total of 1,133 houses but omit the company's declining years. Last is a compilation from the daily sales listed in the "Real Estate Transactions" of the *Newsletter*, 1866-1881, *passim*, checked against T.R.E.A. ads in newspapers. Counting only those properties listed as sold by William Hollis, T.R.E.A. Manager, or by any variant of the company name, this total is 938 houses. This cannot be accurate, because it involves interpretation as to how many new houses, if any, were on each lot sold (construction of a house might cost as little as \$1,000), because the total dollars of these sales differ from those listed in annual reports, and because the discrepancies with other sources lead to the conclusion that other sales existed, either by other sellers or unrecorded in the *Newsletter*. The Associates claimed to build only on its own land. These are the numbers of houses according to:

	<i>Resources</i>	<i>Directories</i>	Compilation
1870-1871	*	13	15
1872	*	51	17
1873	117	120	35
1874	320	316	144
1875	385	355†	320
1876	235	209	201
1877	*	69	103
1878	*	*	86
1879	*	*	11
1880	*	*	6
Total	1,057	1,133	938

* Data not given.

† Source: *Real Estate Circular*, January 1876, 2.

19. *Resources*, February 1875, 3; Roger Olmstead and T. H. Watkins, *Here Today: San Francisco's Architectural Heritage*, San Francisco, 1968, 32-33, 104-105, 113-118.

20. Young, *San Francisco*, 755.

16. Langley, *San Francisco Directory*, 1861, 36, 478-480; 1862, 37, 563-564; 1865, 616; 1867, 39; 1868, 780-781; *San Francisco Newsletter*, 19 June 1869, 19; maps of various homestead associations, California Historical Society.

17. Langley, *San Francisco Directory*, 1869, 21; 1871, 21, 23; *Call*, 26 July 1870, 4; 27 July 1870, 2; *Newsletter*, 20 August 1870, 7; 19 November 1870, 13; 3 December 1870, 11; 10 December 1870, 11; 17 December 1870, 14; 14 January 1871, 14; 28 January 1871, 14; 4 February 1871, 14; 18 February 1871, 15; 25 February 1871, 15; 4 March 1871, 15; 11 March 1871, 15; 29 April 1871, Postscript, 3; 15 July 1871, 12; Thomas Magee, *Real Estate Circular*, November 1870, 2; December 1870, 1; January 1871, 2; February 1871, 2; March 1871, 2; April 1871, 2.

18. An accurate count of the houses T.R.E.A. built is not known to exist.

steps. The appearance of most of these streetscapes has been changed by alterations, such as stuccoing or raising a house to admit a garage under the bay. Except for the corner house, each unit along the street had a door on the same side of the façade. A narrow side yard and a bay or a pair of windows were placed on the other side. The corner house had the bay toward the side street, but often T.R.E.A. sold the corner as a vacant lot intended for a store. Occasionally it built the store, like Basford's, "one of the most tastily built drugstores in town,"²¹ which was located at the southeast corner of Bush and Fillmore Streets (demolished). The corner separated streets of more and less expensive houses. Perhaps unconsciously, T.R.E.A. was following principles of Georgian town planning by providing for a whole community: a few larger and several medium-priced houses on the more important streets, slightly less expensive houses on the side streets, inexpensive houses on interior streets which the company cut through the block.²² Space for markets was also included. The Associates planted evergreens around one block and promised blue gum trees around another, "to add to its attractiveness and health."²³

T.R.E.A. came near to completing this kind of town planning only once, on the block bounded by Mission, Valencia, Twentieth, and Twenty-first Streets. About 1 June 1875, the company purchased this block for \$170,000, less a 40-foot lot on Valencia and subject to a lease on the southern half. The nursery lessee was paid off about six months later for \$6,000.²⁴ Immediately after the original purchase, T.R.E.A. began opening "two narrow streets . . . through the block" and subdividing the whole into about 120 lots (Fig. 5).²⁵ House construction must have been begun right away, for the first house, on Twentieth, was sold late in October 1875. By the end of the year six more, on Mission, had found buyers. In 1876 T.R.E.A. sold 8 houses on Mission, 9 on Twentieth, 10 on Twenty-first, 14 on Valencia, 27 on one of the interior streets, and 14 on the other. In 1877 a dozen more houses were put up. After that the company's fortunes produced only resales and a few sales of lots, including three to its plasterer, Henry Helgoth. In sum, T.R.E.A. sold 99 houses on this land for a total of \$495,187, or an average of \$5,000 apiece.²⁶

21. *Resources*, February 1875, 3; *Newsletter*, 20 February 1875, Postscript, 3; Langley, *Directory*, 1882, 187, 1088.

22. John Summerson, *Georgian London*, London, 1945, 90.

23. *Resources*, February 1875, 3; *San Francisco Evening Bulletin*, 4 March 1876, 1.

24. *Newsletter*, 26 June 1875, Postscript, 8; 29 January 1876, Postscript, 8; William Appleby, *Descriptive Catalogue of Plants*, San Francisco, 1875, cover.

25. *Real Estate Circular*, May 1875, 4.

26. Sales listed in *Newsletter*, 6 November 1875 through 29 November 1879, *passim*.

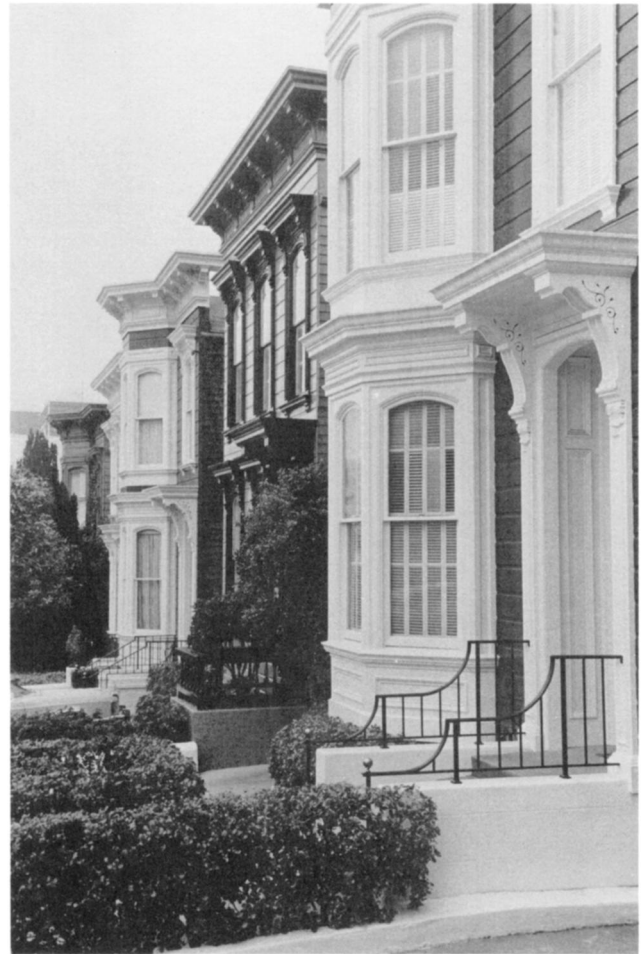


Fig. 3. The Real Estate Associates (T.R.E.A.), 2643–2667 Clay Street, San Francisco, 1874–1875 (author).

The most valuable properties of this or any block were the corners, locations with more light and commercial possibilities. Here were found the largest lots, $24\frac{1}{2} \times 85$ feet to 50×90 feet, as well as the highest prices, an average of \$9,990. Not a single corner house remains intact, but the prices indicate that they were elaborate, and some were described as "palatial." The original owner-occupants were a real estate office (not T.R.E.A.'s), a couple of grocers, all with residences upstairs, a street contractor, an iron works proprietor, a master mariner, and a salesman.²⁷

After the corners, house cost was determined by the importance of the street. Here Mission stood first and foremost. T.R.E.A. subdivided the frontage into lots 25×90 and 35×90 feet. On the smaller lots it built its usual houses, but on the larger lots villas,²⁸ a more expensive and spacious

27. *Ibid.*; Langley, *Directory*, 1882, *passim*; U.S. Census Office, *Population Schedules, Tenth Census 1880*, California, San Francisco County, 11th Ward, Roll #77, leaves 354–359; *Bulletin*, 15 April 1876, 1.

28. T.R.E.A. ad, *Call*, 29 August 1875, 6.



Fig. 4. San Francisco, northeast portion. Locations of lots with houses built and sold by T.R.E.A. shown by solid areas; street railway routes shown by dotted lines. R. J. Seib, Bureau of Engineering, "Map of the City and County of San Francisco," San Francisco, 1974; street railway routes after *Disturnell's Strangers' Guide to San Francisco and Vicinity*, San Francisco, 1883 (San Francisco Department of Public Works; author).

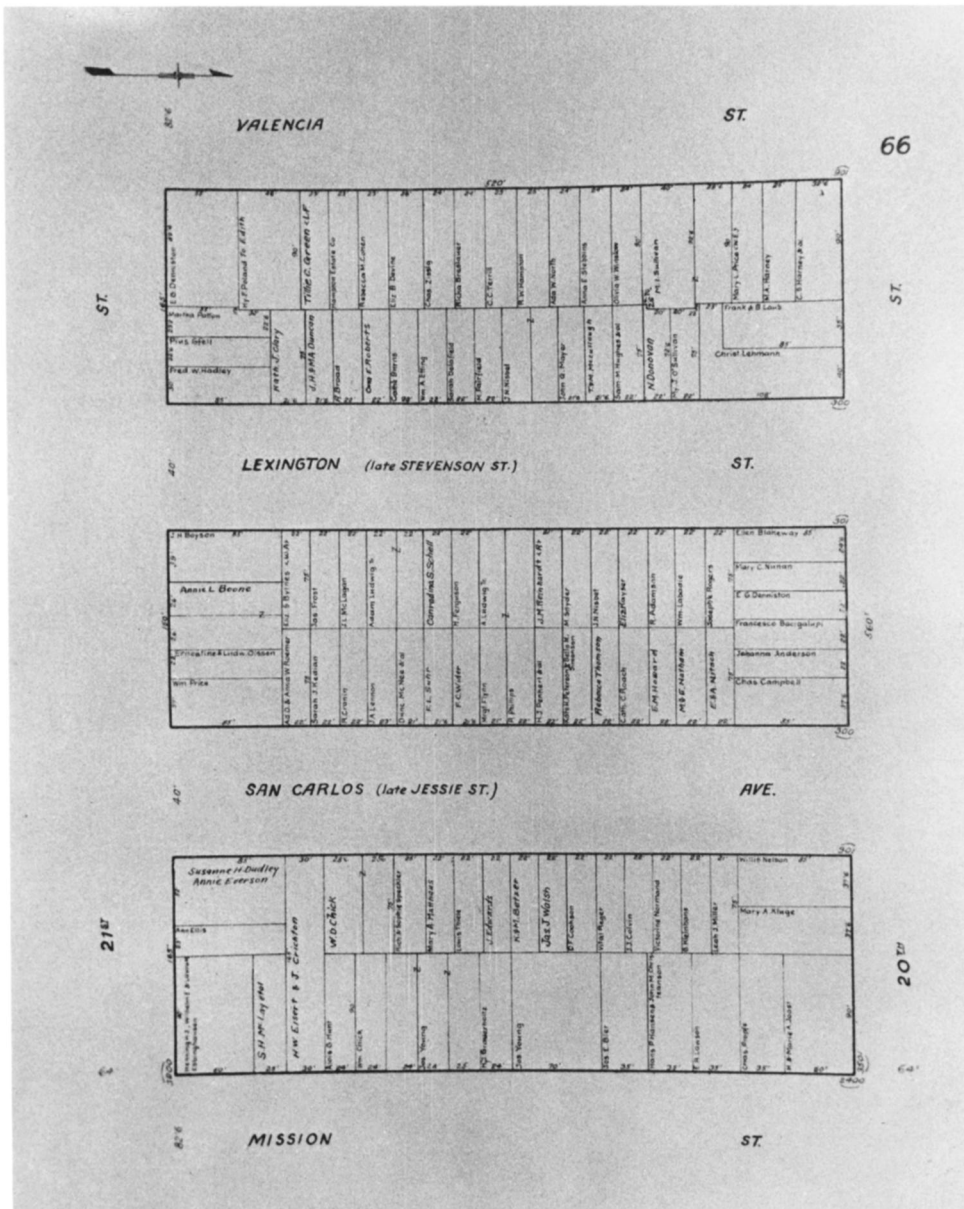


Fig. 5. San Francisco, block bounded by Mission, Valencia, Twentieth, and Twenty-first Streets, as subdivided by T.R.E.A. 1875-1876, *Mery's Block Book of San Francisco*, San Francisco, 1909, 370 (San Francisco Public Library; John Beckham).

type. The houses cost an average of \$7,368 and must have been heavily ornamented. All have been demolished. Owner-residents included an attorney, a photographer, a druggist, and a foundry owner.

Valencia Street was next in the social and economic hierarchy. Its lots are about 25 x 90 feet. The houses cost, on the average, \$5,841 and had bays and conspicuous porticoes (Fig. 6). The original owner-residents included a lumber dealer, a railway freight agent, a ship joiner, a physician, and several clerks.

Twentieth Street followed in importance, with an average house cost of \$5,146, then Twenty-first at \$4,576. Lots on both streets had frontages of 22 to 37½ feet and an 85-foot depth. Probably all the houses had bays, some entrances boasted porticoes, others simpler door hoods; some were

villas. T.R.E.A.'s customers here included barbers, an attorney, and a teacher.

The Associates cut two narrow streets through the block and named them Jessie, now San Carlos, and Stevenson, now Lexington. It subdivided them into lots about 22 x 75 feet and charged an average of \$3,697 on Jessie, the street nearer Mission, and \$3,350 on Stevenson. These smaller houses (Fig. 7) had a reduced version of T.R.E.A.'s typical uniform setback and walkway south of each house. Most of these houses remain. All have Italianate details; a few boast arched pediments over the windows. Some on San Carlos have bays, all on Lexington have flat façades. The buyer-residents were craftsmen, small proprietors, engineers, foremen, and teachers.

The company built its houses in the prevailing local fash-



Fig. 6. T.R.E.A., 929-945
Valencia Street, San Francisco,
1876-1877 (author).



Fig. 7. T.R.E.A., 330-342
Lexington Street, San Francisco,
1876-1877 (author).

ion so that they are hard to distinguish from their contemporaries. All are made of wood and have brick foundations, 10- to 15-foot ceilings, and are never more than two stories; false fronts mask sloping roofs, entrances are up a few steps from the street, detailing is Italianate, and, more often than not, an angled bay rises the full height of the house. Invariably the siding was “channell rustic,”²⁹ horizontally laid. Usually an acanthus leaf terminated the door hood bracket (Fig. 8). The heavy cornices were always the same. One favorite T.R.E.A. device was to alternate details along a particular street, for instance every other house having a bay (Fig. 3), or a particular shape of window top (Fig. 9).

29. *California Architect and Building News*, vi, May 1885, 76.

The house with the bay would be the more expensive; purchasers could choose variations and pay for extras both inside and out. The expensive houses would have features such as entrance porches, Corinthian columns, dentil moldings, pediments, marble fireplaces (Fig. 10). When the company was cutting costs for the mass market, it would simplify the ornamentation: moldings around windows instead of colonnettes and cutwork, rectangular windows instead of arc-headed, and generally fewer decorative elements (Fig. 9).³⁰ All façades were, in Sir John Summerson’s term, “col-

30. *Resources*, February 1875, 3; Archives of the California Supreme Court, “Copy: Cash Book of The Real Estate and Building Associates” (manuscript), Exhibit A, Case #7866, “In the Matter of The Real Estate Associates, A Corporation, In Insolvency,” *passim*.

lated”³¹ from standard offerings of local mills. Some very inexpensive T.R.E.A. houses were described in a local newspaper:

Each building is two-story, and will have a front stoop, circular arch to the door, double bay windows with corniced segment heads, and a well-finished entablament. The interior will contain a staircase hall and four good rooms on the first floor, while on the second-story there will be three roomy apartments, in addition to a bathroom and closets. Nothing in the shape of ornature will distinguish the interior, all rooms being plainly plastered.³²

In a very few locations T.R.E.A. built “villas” on lots at least 35 feet wide. These houses were different in appearance from the usual Italianates. The gable end of their roofs was prominent, and the houses L-shaped. Bay and entrance were separate, one-story pieces. The remaining three (Fig. 11) are textbook examples of the American Italian Villa of the 1850s and 1860s.³³ Each is an asymmetrical grouping of rectilinear blocks which individually are symmetrical. The roof is picturesque, with deeply projecting overhang and eaves supported by brackets. There is a pair of windows and a bay window. However the T.R.E.A. Italian villas lacked tower and veranda. They had eight or nine rooms and cost \$5,000 to \$7,000. The company built fewer than 40, and later builders did not repeat the type, presumably because its wider lot requirement meant fewer houses could be sold on a given street frontage.

The plan of a typical 19th-century San Francisco house contained entrance hall and stairs on one side, rooms on the other.³⁴ Center rooms received light from windows facing a narrow side yard. The house seldom stood more than two stories high, since it could have plenty of well-lighted rooms on each floor. T.R.E.A. used this standard plan (Fig. 12) and in addition created its own standard relationship to light. Bay and side windows admitted maximum light by being placed to the south on north-south streets, or to the east side on east-west streets. Thus the hall was on the north or west side of the house, along the lot line, leaving open yard only to the south or east. Windows facing west were avoided, because San Francisco’s pronounced westerly winds in the afternoon, combined in that era with great expanses of sand, made them unpleasant and dirty.

The Associates advertised its houses as “of modern style and finish” and having “modern conveniences.” Listings for its very first houses, 15 of them at the northwest corner

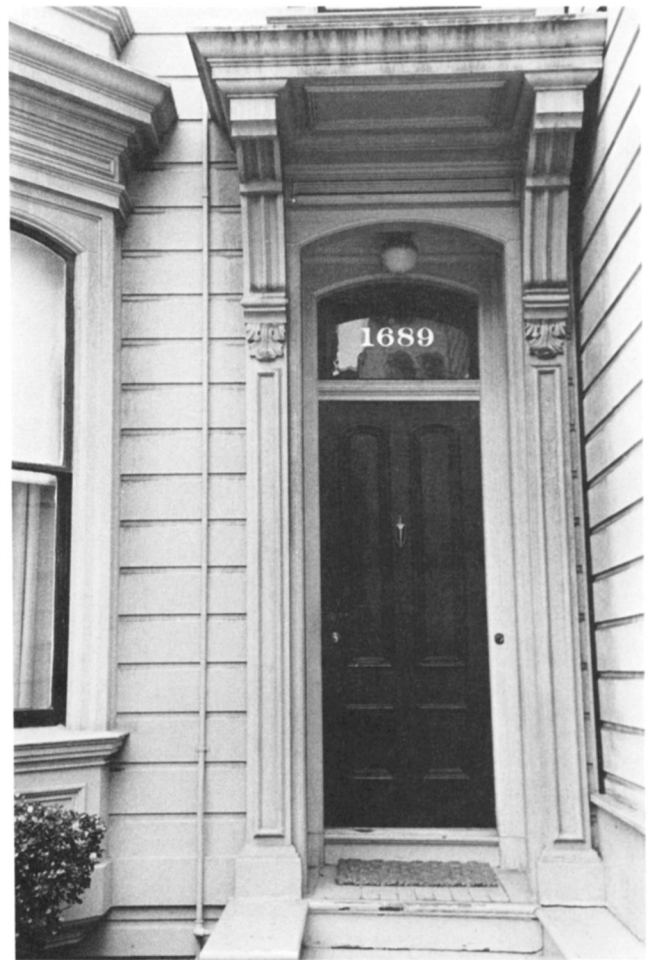


Fig. 8. T.R.E.A., 1689 Sutter Street, San Francisco, 1875. Doorway (author).

of Sacramento and Fillmore Streets, invited prospective purchasers to the office “to examine plans.”³⁵ These plans, which did not change during the decade of its activity, may have come from a pattern book, from a company director in the real estate business, or from the director who had been a house carpenter in the 1850s.³⁶ Each house contained six to ten rooms. A T.R.E.A. specialty, even for inexpensive houses, was stairs which curved at the top (Figs. 12 and 13). Outside, decorative features did not intrude on the façade’s architectural lines. Post and lintel were never broken by lozenge or keystone, and a one-story bay was seldom built on a two-story house. If bands were indicated for the colonnettes between bay windows, they were placed at the middle

31. Summerson, *Georgian London*, 149.

32. *Alta California*, 30 September 1872, 1.

33. Marcus Whiffen, *American Architecture since 1780*, Cambridge, MA, 1969, 69; Talbot Hamlin, *Architecture through the Ages*, New York, 1940, 594.

34. Lockwood, *Bricks and Brownstone*, 14, 70, 164–167, 228, shows similar plans in the usual New York row house.

35. *Call*, 13 October 1871, 1.

36. T.R.E.A. ad, *Real Estate Circular*, January 1870, 4, shows Edward Barry as President, William Hollis as Manager, Secretary, and a director. The *Directory* lists both in real estate. Another director was D. A. MacDonald; see Oscar Shuck, *Sketches of Leading Representative Men of San Francisco*, San Francisco, 1875, 781; *Newsletter*, 30 October 1875, Postscript, 3.



Fig. 9. John Remer for T.R.E.A., 2315–2319 Webster Street, San Francisco, 1878. Original selling prices, left to right: \$3,800, \$4,100, unknown: William Hollis's residence 1879–1885, mortgage \$2,000 (author).



Fig. 10. T.R.E.A., 1712 (left) and 1710 Bush Street, San Francisco, 1875. Original selling prices: \$10,498 and \$9,025 (author).

sash line. This relative restraint in ornamentation characterizes a T.R.E.A. house.

Although the company publicized its reliance on the architectural profession, its influence is not discernible. The first notice of 1875 concerned two houses on Sutter built “to order from designs drawn by the architect of the Associ-

ates.”³⁷ This was Silas P. Ford, who listed himself as an architect, but only in the 1875 *Directory*. He was really a carpenter-builder-contractor who served from 1874 into 1876 as the Superintendent of T.R.E.A.'s Building Depart-

37. *Resources*, February 1875, 3.



Fig. 11. T.R.E.A., Villa, 2373 California Street, San Francisco, 1876 (author).

ment. Probably Ford's designs concerned only ornaments and interior arrangements for customers who were buying unfinished houses.

The first professional architect known to be associated with the company was David Farquharson,³⁸ who designed not its houses but its office building. His name is shown as architect on Eadweard Muybridge's photograph of the T.R.E.A. Building (Fig. 14).

New York theater architect John A. Remer (1844 or 1845 – ca. 1901)³⁹ worked on The Associates' later houses. The

38. Farquharson was born in Scotland 1827, received British architectural training, came to California 1850, and died San Francisco 1914. He built the ten-columned Greek Revival Sacramento Courthouse (1854), the Sansovino-inspired Bank of California (1867), and South Hall, the first and only remaining early building on the Berkeley campus of the University of California. See Kirker, *California's Architectural Frontier*, 50, 51, 58, 73, 84, 90, 207; Barber and Baker, *Sacramento Illustrated*, reprint, Sacramento, 1950, 85; Shuck, *Historical Abstract of San Francisco*, San Francisco, 1897, 89; Verne A. Stadtman, ed., *The Centennial Record of the University of California*, Berkeley, 1967, 55.

39. Remer had come to San Francisco from his native New York in 1875 to design Baldwin's Hotel and Theater, a luxury hotel competing with John P. Gaynor's contemporary Palace. Theater expert Remer had probably been recommended to "Lucky" Baldwin by his theater manager, Thomas Ma-

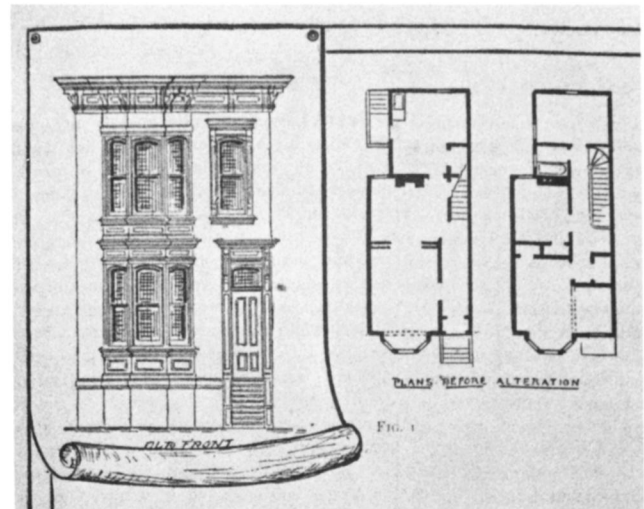


Fig. 12. T.R.E.A., northeast corner of Twenty-first and Bartlett Streets, San Francisco, 1876, demolished. Plan from *California Architect and Building News*, vi, August 1885, 133 (Judith Lynch Waldhorn).



Fig. 13. 1513 Golden Gate Avenue, stairs seen from entrance hall (author).

1878 *Directory* reported that T.R.E.A.'s "plans, elevations and working drawings are prepared by John A. Remer, the well-known architect of Baldwin's Hotel, who is regularly employed by the company."⁴⁰ On 12 January 1880 Remer received \$15 for "Buildings Jackson & Webster," a residual payment as the last of those houses had been sold ten months earlier, and \$55 for "Buildings Sutter & Buchanan," less than 1% of the money T.R.E.A. spent at that location.⁴¹ Remer had his office *gratis* in the T.R.E.A. Building, bought two T.R.E.A. houses on Buchanan Street, and lived in one of them with his wife and five children from 1878 to 1881.⁴² However, the houses Remer worked on (Fig. 9) are indistinguishable from the company's earlier ones.

The Real Estate Associates was incorporated in September 1866 as a modest enterprise, listed in directories with the homestead associations. The Certificate of Incorporation declared its business to be the buying, selling, improving, and managing of real estate, and lending money thereon. The stock certificates bore the motto "Land is the basis of all security." In its first year and a half of existence, less than \$30,000 was paid in as stock subscriptions; it borrowed an equal amount and spent over \$36,000 on real estate. Sales came to only \$303. The founding directors were all small fish in the San Francisco pond, four of them bookkeepers, four in insurance, and three in real estate. The president was shortly to open a men's clothing store which still exists, Bullock & Jones. At first The Associates merely bought and sold unimproved land, often breaking tracts into house-

guire, who was associated with the Richard M. Hooley for whom Remer had designed the post-Chicago fire Hooley's Opera House of that city (1872). Remer was also credited with New York's Lyceum Theater (first of that name) and Union Square Theater (1871), and with Wade's Opera House in San Francisco (1876). The last had been commenced in 1873 with S. C. Bugbee & Son as architects. Financial reverses caused suspension for a year, and Remer's name may have become associated with the building for taking over the completion. After working for T.R.E.A. Remer executed various works in and near San Francisco. He altered San Jose's Brohaska Opera House. He constructed a brick building to house a gasometer for the Palace and Grand Hotels. He won a competition and designed Bacon Hall (1880) for the University of California at Berkeley. For Reinhardt Daemon, Remer built the Casino restaurant west of the conservatory in Golden Gate Park. Late in 1881 Remer sold his T.R.E.A.-built houses and moved back to New York. See Lloyd, *Lights and Shades*, 155-157, 370-376; Langley, *Directory*, 1874, 29-30; 1875, 31-32; 1876, 12, 27; *California Historical Quarterly*, xxi, 1942, 153-176, 241; John William Snyder, "A Partial Index to the *California Architect and Building News*, 1 April 1879 to 20 June 1900," Master's thesis, University of California, Davis, undated ca. 1976, 411, Appendix I, 207, Appendix II, 8, 41; Remer's listings, *Trow's New York City Directory*, 1871/1872, 1875, 1877, 1887, 1888, 1893, 1896, 1900/1901 (Remer was not listed in *Trow's* 1862, 1883, 1902, 1910).

40. Langley, *Directory*, 1878, 12.

41. "Cash Book," 3 and *passim*.

42. *CA&BN*, 1, June 1880, viii; 11, June 1881, viii; *Newsletter*, 21 January 1877, Postscript, 4; 22 December 1877, 11. The "Cash Book," 6, 12, does not list Remer among those paying rent for offices in the T.R.E.A. Building; *Census* 1880, San Francisco, part of 13th Ward, Roll #77, leaf 145.

sized lots as the homestead associations did. It turned a profit of \$116,500 in 1869, the company's only acknowledged net profit on record.⁴³

The new decade brought changes. The number of directors decreased, and most of the original ones were re-

43. The Real Estate Associates, *Constitution and By-Laws*, 1868; *Resources*, April 1877, 1; Langley, *Directories*, late 1860s, *passim*. The company's finances are discussed in more detail below.

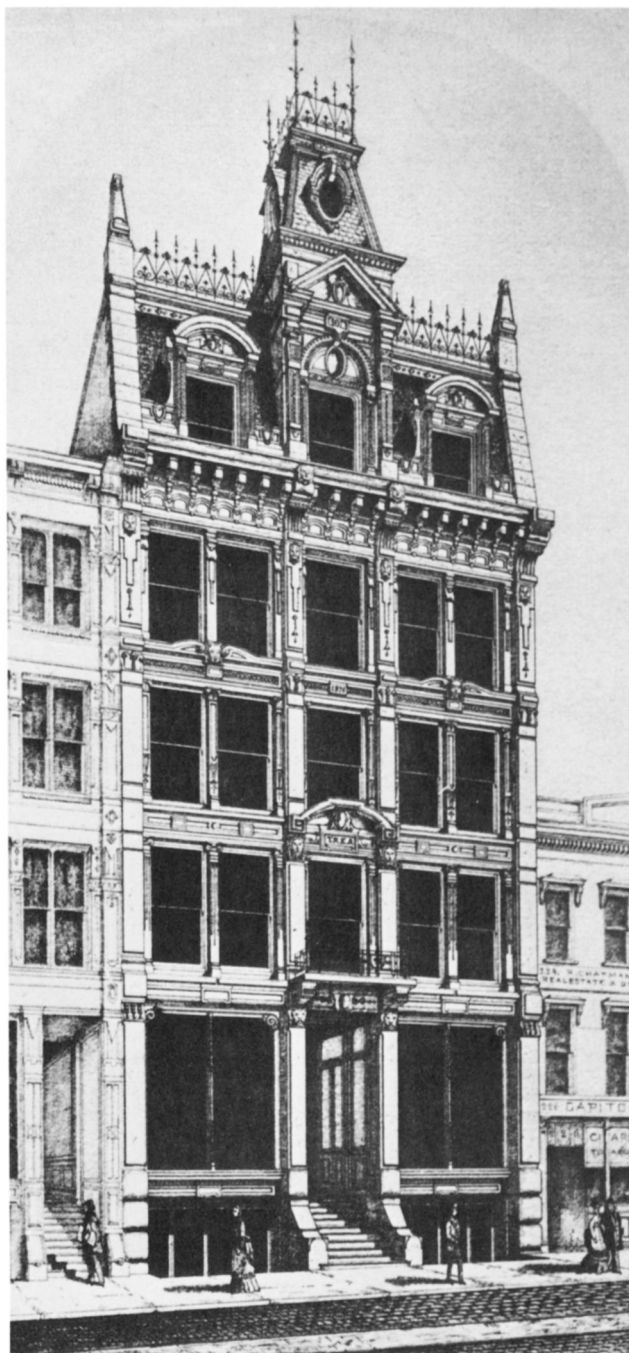


Fig. 14. David Farquharson, T.R.E.A. Building, 230 Montgomery Street, San Francisco, 1876-1877, demolished (California Historical Society; Eadweard Muybridge).

placed by men who could help the company's new venture, house building. B. H. Freeman owned a firm of stair builders, scrollsawyers, and wood turners, and D. A. MacDonald a planing mill. Maurice Dore was a real estate auctioneer, William Sutton bookkeeper of a lumber company. Edward Barry and William Hollis were real estate specialists. C. S. Swenson had money from a waterfront boarding house to invest. None of them appears to have had much, if any, experience in construction. Profit from increasing land values continued to be the company's main interest, and it built houses only on its own land.⁴⁴

These men ventured slowly into house construction. The first dwellings were begun some time in 1870. In November of that year, The Associates advertised for "subscribers" to houses being built at the northwest corner of Sacramento and Fillmore Streets. In June and July 1871 it sold a complete row of eight detached houses on Sacramento, five on Fillmore, and one each on Clay and Steiner. Of these 15 buyers, 11 were connected in one way or another with T.R.E.A.'s business. Three owned planing mills, one was a plumber, another a city surveyor, and another the financial editor of the *Daily Evening Bulletin*. The lumber dealer received his house as a "gift." T.R.E.A. Directors Hollis, MacDonald, Freeman, and Sutton bought adjacent houses. They were not speculating. Of the 15 buyers, 14 moved in immediately, and four of them were still there ten years later. Three had moved into other T.R.E.A. houses.⁴⁵

With the start of house construction, the company also began its only structure erected on land other than its own. The plot probably belonged to the New Montgomery Street Real Estate Company, a speculation of William Ralston and Asbury Harpending, which was spending \$2,000,000 of the Bank of California's money buying and developing a south-of-Market extension to the main business street. T.R.E.A. President Dore was their auctioneer, and he may have arranged the contract for The Associates on the east side of New Montgomery Street from Minna to Natoma. The two-story brick building was capped by a mansard roof. The second floor contained a hall for the Grand Army of the Republic. This venture presumably generated less profit than the houses, because T.R.E.A. did not construct any more business blocks except, at the height of its activity, its own office building.⁴⁶

In 1872, the company continued to build and sell houses on its block of land, and commenced work near the Hayes Park Pavilion. The next year The Associates purchased its first tract south of Market Street, built and sold 18 houses on it, in addition to houses at other locations. Remarkable increases continued through 1874 and 1875. After that banner year, in which about 350 houses were sold, T.R.E.A.'s activities dwindled until its bankruptcy in 1881.

On the crest of its prosperity in 1875, the company decided to construct its own office building in the heart of the business district. One day late in April, T.R.E.A. bought two parcels from capitalist Daniel Meyer. One was a full Western Addition block where the company immediately erected 10-room houses on 27½-foot lots. The other was a 44-foot frontage on Montgomery Street across from the Nevada Bank due to open in October, around the corner from the Stock Exchange's building site, and next door to the location where the Mills Building would go up in 1892. On this \$138,000 lot the company decided to erect The Real Estate Associates Building, 230 Montgomery (Fig. 14), which would house its own offices as well as a great deal of rental space.⁴⁷

Architect David Farquharson designed a flat-fronted, six-story building whose window size and narrow supporting members suggest an iron frame, though contemporary reports speak of a brick building with granite front and slated mansard. Farquharson had already placed bearing columns in the brick walls of the Nevada Bank, which were revealed by the 1906 earthquake. A combination of Greek Revival and Second Empire motifs decorated the building.⁴⁸

Of the \$90,000 in construction costs, the façade's incised and carved granite accounted for \$25,000. It came from G. Griffith's quarry at Penryn, Placer County, California, which was supplying granite for San Francisco's U.S. Mint (1869–1874), its third City Hall (1870–1894), the Stock Exchange (1875–1877), and portions of the wooden mansions of Stanford, Crocker, and Hopkins. The high-ceilinged interior was serviced by an elevator and housed numerous

44. *Real Estate Circular*, January 1870, 2; January 1871, 4; September 1873, 4; October 1876, 3; Langley, *Directory*, 1876, 13; 1878, 12; 1870s, *passim*.

45. *Real Estate Circular*, November 1870, 4; *Newsletter*, 3 June 1871, Postscript, 2; 10 June 1871, 13; 24 June 1871, 13; 1 July 1871, 13; 8 July 1871, 13; Langley, *Directory*, 1872, 1873, and 1882, *passim*.

46. Langley, *Directory*, 1871, 25; 1871–1893, *passim*, for names on photograph; photographs of New Montgomery Street, 1885, and the Grand

Hotel, ca. 1872, San Francisco Public Library; Asbury Harpending, *The Great Diamond Hoax*, San Francisco, 1913, 115, 141–142; George D. Lyman, *Ralston's Ring*, New York and London, 1937, 82, 120–121, 228–229; David Lavender, *Nothing Seemed Impossible: William C. Ralston and Early San Francisco*, Palo Alto, 1975, 248; "Map of Property of New Montgomery Street between Market & Howard Streets to be sold at AUCTION thursday MAY 6th, 1869, by Maurice Dore & Co.," San Francisco, 1869.

47. *Newsletter*, 1 May 1875, Postscript, 3; *Real Estate Circular*, March 1875, 1.

48. *Resources*, April 1877, 1; *Real Estate Circular*, July 1876, 1; John Cotter Pelton, "San Francisco, Its Position in Architectural and Constructive Development," *Modern San Francisco 1907–1908*, Western Press Association, publisher, no date, no page.

offices, all of which were leased for a monthly total of \$2,400 during the first year.⁴⁹

All the company's activities must be credited to the initiative of one man, William Hollis, 1839–1895 (Fig. 15). T.R.E.A.'s Manager throughout its existence, its Secretary 1866–1873, and President 1874–1882, Hollis was “the life and soul of that concern.”⁵⁰

Born in Iowa en route from Canada, Hollis was the second child in a pioneer family of six. In the year of his birth, his father and uncle settled beside the Mississippi in Elk River Township, Clinton County, Iowa, and helped incorporate it. At the age of 13, William came overland to California and searched for gold in Michigan Bluff, Placer County. In 1861 he married Sarah Favor, teacher of German and daughter of an obstetrician there. Probably he spent his entire life west of the Mississippi and never saw the East coast prototypes of the housing tracts for which he was responsible.⁵¹

In 1860 Hollis moved to San Francisco and read law. He also served as a clerk, a mining secretary, and a clothing store manager. From 1862 through 1866 he was statewide secretary of the Sons of Temperance, a national organization strong enough to have carried the gold country in an 1855 state plebiscite for a dry law. Later he joined the Masons. He seems to have drifted into real estate first as a sideline, involving himself with several homestead associations. As president of the Central Park Homestead Association, which had a tract on the north slope of Hunters Point,

49. *Newsletter*, 20 December 1879, 28; “Cash Book,” Account #64, 6, 12; *Real Estate Circular*, November 1877, 4; sole evidence for existence of the elevator is in a three-page manuscript, Archives of the California Supreme Court, “William Hale, Receiver The Real Estate Associates, costs of running building,” Case #8160, “In the Matter of The Real Estate Associates, a Corporation, In Insolvency.” Submitted to the Court on 11 November 1881, these costs include five small items for “Repairs to elevator,” total \$33.85. Regular monthly costs of running the building include \$50 for janitor, \$20 for engineer, and \$100 for steam.

Opening of the building had been delayed by a plasterers' strike. Early in April 1877 the men went out over the company's refusal to fire two non-union plasterers and pay \$4 for an eight-hour day. In about a week this placard went up on the uncompleted T.R.E.A. Building: “Wanted, 100 plasterers to work ten hours a day, wages four dollars.” That no plasterers turned up shows the union's remarkable solidarity, especially in the face of the immense and increasing unemployment in that third month after a mining-stock panic had burst over California. The ensuing depression was to linger into the 1880s and contribute to the death of T.R.E.A. The brave plasterers' strike was also a casualty, for the union settled on May first for the terms on the placard. Fate of the union shop is unknown. See: *Newsletter*, 14 April 1877, 16; *San Francisco Examiner*, 7 April 1877, 3; *Bulletin*, 1 May 1877, 2.

50. *Real Estate Circular*, March 1877, 4.

51. *Sixth Census* 1840, Iowa, Clinton County, leaf 13; *Seventh Census* 1850, Iowa, Clinton County, Elk River Township, leaf 292; *Eighth Census* 1860, California, Placer County, Michigan Bluff, 809, dwl. #933; *Tenth Census* 1880, California, San Francisco County, part 12th Ward, roll #78, leaf 45; Lucius P. Allen, *History of Clinton County, Iowa* (Chicago, 1879), 618; “Death of W. Hollis,” *Call*, 30 June 1895, 7.



Fig. 15. William Hollis, *San Francisco Call*, 30 June 1895, 7 (Bancroft Library, University of California, Berkeley).

and secretary-manager of T.R.E.A., he finally moved into real estate full time and stayed there.⁵²

Unassuming and “a genial companion,” Hollis became “one of the best judges of real estate in this city.”⁵³ He was known for his energy, clear judgment, and ability to buy land cheaply. He was proud to sell houses to “serve the great middle class” and “transform the sandy wastes outside the business part of the city into . . . neighborhoods, composed of frugal and industrious people.”⁵⁴ The 1877 *Directory* presents Hollis as an idealist, who early in 1871 drove the editor out to see three blocks of land the company had acquired. Nothing but sand met the eye. But Hollis “rose up in his buggy” and excitedly proclaimed his vision of creating a community and, given a little more land, of bringing “the whole of San Francisco out here to reside.”⁵⁵

52. Hollis's listings, *Directories*, 1861–1895; *Great Register of San Francisco*, 1867; William Hanchett, “The Question of Religion and the Taming of California, 1849–1854,” *California Historical Quarterly*, xxxii, 1953, 131–132; Langley, *Directory*, 1867, 687; Brooks and Rouleau, *Abstract of Title of Lands of the Central Park Homestead Association*, San Francisco, 1866, map.

53. “A Contractor's Death,” *Bulletin*, 26 June 1895; *Real Estate Circular*, March 1877, 4.

54. Langley, *Directory*, 1877, 12; 1876, 13.

55. Langley, *Directory*, 1877, 11. Perhaps this writer was the *Bulletin* editor who bought one of the first 15 houses, which were built on the middle of the three blocks.

This idealism was combined in Hollis with some ruthless and shady business practices. The best demonstration of them appears in the transcript of a land title lawsuit, *Voll vs. Hollis*. Hollis had agreed to purchase land on Buchanan Street if the seller could get clear possession. The process of getting possession came to resemble a grade-B western, with destruction by night, forcible takeover by day in overwhelming numbers, and unceasing armed watch, all punctuated by gunshots which may or may not have been random. Hollis remained in his office downtown and paid his combatants' wages. But when the contesting claimant arrived with police to arrest the participants, who should turn up but William Hollis, with a buggyload of silver, in boxes, for bail. His timely arrival suggests collusion with the police. The rival claimant was told to give up, as "That is the man who runs the Courts," and "here is the money that can take any land, that can buy judges and juries."⁵⁶ Hollis won the case.

His knack for getting T.R.E.A. noticed in the press has provided virtually all that is known of the company's finances. A huge publicity article in *The Resources of California*, April 1877, timed just before the opening of the T.R.E.A. Building, included extracts from financial statements for the calendar years 1867 through 1876. Thomas Magee, in his *Real Estate Circular*, summarized financial reports for the company's best years, 1869, 1874, 1875, and 1876.⁵⁷ It is quite possible that these figures were manipulated to show the company in the most favorable light. For instance, dividends were paid in 1872, 1873, 1875, 1876, and 1877, when the company appears not to have been making a profit. Either the "dividends" were what would now be called interest on deposits, or the company paid them out of capital to bolster the price of its stock by artificially stimulating stockholder confidence. Some additional financial information can be computed from the company's 15-page "Cash Book," covering 19 December 1879 through 24 March 1881, during which time its activities subsided from little to nothing.

From such sources, T.R.E.A.'s financial structure can, in part, be analyzed. It began with capital listed at \$120,000, subscribed in monthly payments by stockholders. By 1869 that amount had been doubled twice through new stock issues. The 1875 report claimed a capital stock of a million dollars. The company earned income from rents, commissions, interest, profits on land sales, and monthly mortgage

payments. In addition, standard bank loans were necessary because Hollis constantly bought land, paying out more than twice the value of his land sales each year through 1872, and well over a million dollars in 1875 alone. The company also advertised for funds to be invested in it by prospective customers. It issued special "Homestead Shares" of stock which were to be paid in monthly installments and exchanged as the down payment on a T.R.E.A. house. Later, customers were invited to deposit funds with The Associates as if it were a bank.⁵⁸

Consideration of the interest paid on these accounts illustrates T.R.E.A.'s fiscal fragility. The company received interest on mortgages and on moneys it deposited with banks. It paid interest to its own depositors and to the banks from which it borrowed money. For interest paid and that received the rates were the same, 8 to 10% a year, the local standard.⁵⁹ The company made no allowances for its own administrative expenses and, besides, usually operated with a fairly heavy debt load. If the San Francisco real estate market had continued rising as it did in the late 1860s and mid-1870s, T.R.E.A. might have been able to pay its real debt costs out of sales at increased land values. Without such rises, the debt load spelled trouble.

The financial reports also show the depth of the company's commitment to land. Estimated value of its real estate never dropped to below 58% of assets, and it was 82% of assets, or \$1,517,450, at the end of 1876, the last year for which information is known. Each year T.R.E.A. bought as much land as possible, in cash, \$90,000 to \$1,090,592 worth. Most of the purchases were in the Mission or the Western Addition, some in such marginal areas as the vicinity of cemeteries or the lot claimed by the city for a hospital (now Duboce Park). Tracts ranged in size from a 50-foot street frontage to three contiguous 254 x 412½-foot blocks (Fig. 4). Often The Associates had to purchase a single parcel from several different claimants, but it sold the product with clear title.

Following purchase, work began on grading, made easier by the sand which covers most of San Francisco. However, in one known case, the block just south of Market Street across from the present U.S. Mint, T.R.E.A.'s laborers removed serpentine rock 30 feet deep in just one month. In

56. No. 6868, *In the Supreme Court of the State of California*, F. W. Voll et al., *Plaintiffs and Appellants*, vs. William Hollis et al., *Defendants and Respondents*, *Transcript on Appeal* . . . , San Francisco, 1879, 7 and *passim*.

57. January 1870, 2; January 1875, 4; January 1876, 2, 4; January 1877, 2, 4.

58. *Call*, 5 January 1874, 1; 1 January 1875, 3; The Real Estate Associates, *Certificate of Incorporation*, San Francisco, 1868.

59. Langley, *Directory*, 1871, 23; *Real Estate Circular*, March 1873, 3; October 1876, 3; January 1878, 3; *Call*, 5 January 1874, 1; 1 January 1875, 1; The Real Estate Associates, *Catalogue of Property for Sale by The Real Estate Associates*, San Francisco, 1877, inside front cover and inside back cover; "Mortgages" and "Real Estate Transactions," *Examiner*, 1878, *passim*; Ira Cross, *Financing an Empire*, Chicago, San Francisco, and Los Angeles, 1927, 11, 797.



Fig. 16. T.R.E.A., retaining wall and 1848 (left) and 1836 Pine Street, San Francisco, 1875 (author).

another case, a still-extant retaining wall had to be built on Pine Street, west of Gough (Fig. 16).⁶⁰

Construction would begin as soon as title was clear. On one tract house frames were going up within a week of purchase. On another, 41 houses were completed five months after purchase. Obviously some sort of mass production was taking place, and construction went on at several locations at once.⁶¹

The Associates constructed its houses by standard methods, with balloon frames. The first known Superintendent of the Construction Department was Silas P. Ford, 1874–1876. After him came John B. Gonyeau, 1877–1881. Both men had previous experience as carpenters and struck out on their own as master builders after working for T.R.E.A. With foremen, they supervised up to 300 or 400 “mechanics” at a time, hired directly by the company in all crafts except plumbing, and collectively paid out \$10,000 a week. The company boasted that its workmen were all “day labor.”⁶²

60. *Real Estate Circular*, August 1876, 1; September 1876, 1; *Resources*, February 1875, 3.

61. *Resources*, February 1875, 3.

62. Langley, *Directory*, 1876, 13; *Bulletin*, 22 January 1876, 1. Lockwood, *Manhattan Moves Uptown*, 68, explains that in New York men on “‘day’s work’ . . . were paid by the day [instead of by contract] and expected to do

Wages for day labor came to about one-third of construction costs. Another third was spent on lumber—T.R.E.A.’s suppliers had mills in Mendocino, California, where redwoods grow (John Kentfield & Co.), and in Tacoma, Washington (Hanson, Ackerson & Co.). An eighth of construction costs paid for millwork (mills such as D. A. MacDonald’s Enterprise, and B. & J. S. Doe). The rest went to suppliers of plumbing, paints and oils, glass, and hardware.⁶³

To find buyers for all these houses, T.R.E.A. advertised liberally and held auctions almost annually. The monthly *Real Estate Circular* carried ads for the first houses and later a brief announcement. The *Daily Morning Call* published

the highest quality work.” In San Francisco ‘day work’ may have had the New York connotations. Alternately or in addition it may have carried political overtones in relation to the large numbers of immigrants, the strong union situation, and/or the factors that made a success of the Workingmen’s Party.

63. In building its last three houses, The Associates contracted out the stair building (G. K. Lawson), plastering (Helgoth, Ferguson), drayage (Lane & Pullen), and house painting (Lang & Griffith), as well as the plumbing (Sweeny & Vance). It also made payments to suppliers of embossed and cut glass (John Mallon), marble (J. & F. Kessler), paints (J. R. Kelly & Co.), plaster decorations (Samuel Kellet), stoves and tinware (Schuster Brothers), patent brick (Patent Brick Co.), sewerpipe (J. B. Owens), hardware (Huntington & Hopkins), fancy goods (Davis Brothers), and lime and cement (Davis & Cowell). See: Langley, *Directory*, 1876, 13; “Cash Book,” *passim*.

T.R.E.A. ads two or three times a week from October 1871 through December 1878 (Fig. 17). Headed by the T.R.E.A. logo, these ads emphasized buying on "the installment plan." Their most obvious feature was the lists of locations where houses were being offered for sale. One or two of the five to 16 locations might feature villas. The fine print mentioned convenience to street railways, title, day labor, the company supervision, and the facts that the houses were all new, detached, and modern. Similar ads were found in the *Examiner*, the *Chronicle*, and the *Bulletin*. The very last T.R.E.A. ad was a three-line mention in the "Improvements in Progress" column of the June 1880 *California Architect and Building Review*. There were also ads for auctions, held in April 1873, November 1875, April 1877, February 1878, and March 1879. Each auction had its own catalogue, detailing payments and showing maps of all the blocks where property was being offered.⁶⁴

Customers usually bought T.R.E.A. houses as their own residences. People listed in the *Newsletter* as buyers of the firm's more expensive houses, \$6,000 and up, appeared in directories as doctors, lawyers, mining secretaries, "capitalists," publishers, proprietors of stores and factories, and the Spanish consul. The least expensive houses, \$2,500 to \$4,000, attracted buyers who were craftsmen or in jobs such as were noted on Jessie and Stevenson. Inexpensive houses on Webster were bought by a bartender, a starch factory worker, a plumber, and a porter. One \$3,000 house on Pearl Street was bought and lived in by Denis Kearney,⁶⁵ drayman, soon to be the famous sandlot orator, a founder of the local Workingmen's Party which elected a San Francisco mayor and passed a new State Constitution.

Some consistency existed among buyers on particular streets. People tended to buy near friends and relations, and the limited price range on one street would group buyers of similar means. In addition, certain social restrictions may have been imposed or encouraged by the company in its efforts to boost sales. The 1870 ad promised the first house subscribers a chance to approve all subsequent subscribers. This sentence never appeared again, perhaps because it proved too cumbersome or hindered sales. However, names of a single nationality dominated some T.R.E.A. streets. For instance, Irish names were listed as buyers on the east side of Valencia Street north of Twenty-first, and German names on the same side of the same street in the next block south.

Most of the customers took advantage of T.R.E.A.'s in-

64. *Call*, 21 June 1875, 1; *Examiner*, 1 May 1877, 2; *Chronicle*, 2 May 1877, 2; *Bulletin*, 11 July 1878, 1; *Real Estate Circular*, March 1873, 3; November 1875, 3; March 1877, 4; January 1878, 1; February 1878, 1; February 1879, 2; *Resources*, April 1877, 1; *Real Estate Associates, Catalogue*, 1877.

65. *Newsletter*, 6 September 1873, 4; *Langley, Directory*, 1874, 365.



The Real Estate Associates

OFFER THE FOLLOWING

HOUSES and LOTS

On the Installment Plan.

- 4 Houses north side Eddy street, between Scott and Divisadero; 6 rooms.
- 2 Houses east side Divisadero street, between Eddy and Ellis; 6 rooms.
- 2 Houses west side Gough street, between Post and Geary; 10 rooms.
- 2 Houses west side Capp street, between Seventeenth and Eighteenth; 6 rooms.
- 2 Villas south side Nineteenth street, between Mission and Valencia; 8 rooms.
- 4 Houses east side Guerrero street, between Ridley and Quinn; 6 rooms.
- 9 Houses east side Howard street, between Thirteenth and Fourteenth; 10 rooms.
- 1 House south side Sacramento street, between Fillmore and Steiner; 6 rooms.
- 1 House south side Sutter street, between Octavia and Laguna; 6 rooms.
- 1 House north side California street, between Webster and Fillmore; 8 rooms.
- 3 Houses south side Sacramento street, between Webster and Fillmore; 7 rooms.
- 6 Houses south side Clay street, between Pierce and Steiner; 6 rooms.
- 3 Houses east side Pierce street, between Sacramento and Clay; 6 rooms.
- 10 Houses north side Vallejo street, between Jones and Leavenworth; 8 rooms.
- 4 Houses west side Mission street, between Nineteenth and Twentieth; 8 rooms.

The Houses are all entirely new, are of modern construction and finish, and easily accessible by street railroads.

They are entirely disconnected, have been built under our own supervision, by DAY WORK, and are warranted first-class in every respect. The title warranted perfect in all cases.

This advertisement will be changed from day to day, as sales are made or new building enterprises inaugurated.

WM. HOLLIS, Manager.

220-cod:111

204 Montgomery St.

Fig. 17. T.R.E.A., advertisement, *San Francisco Chronicle*, 9 May 1875 (San Francisco Public Library; John Beckham).

stallment plan method of purchase. The company's advertising stressed the ease of payment: only one-fifth to one-half the purchase price down, the rest paid over one to 12 years in monthly installments which included interest of 8 to 10% a year. T.R.E.A. claimed that "not over one-third [of its customers] could have ever hoped to have owned a home" were it not for the company's mass construction economies and, especially, financing.⁶⁶ The Associates held the mortgages, rather than conveying them to banks, which permitted great latitude in accepting risks in order to sell more houses, but also proved vulnerable to depression.

Holding mortgages may be considered one of the company's fatal weaknesses, along with borrowing too much at too high rates, charging insufficient interest on mortgages, spending more each year for land and construction than sales brought in, and perhaps pricing houses too low in relation to costs. These weaknesses and a four-year-long depression caused the end of The Real Estate Associates.⁶⁷

When mining stocks fell precipitously in January 1877, involving most of the populace, Hollis responded energetically and immediately by selling undeveloped lots in greater numbers than his usual practice. It was not enough. Too many mortgages had to be called in, no one was willing to buy, and construction had already been reduced drastically. T.R.E.A. had to suspend the June 1877 dividend. It hung on, with occasional spurts of activity, but virtually ended all business except sales in November 1878.⁶⁸

Hoping to hang on until the economy should permit him to recover, Hollis took evasive action.⁶⁹ After being ousted

66. Langley, *Directory*, 1876, 13.

67. *Newsletter*, 5 March 1881, 18; *Resources*, April 1877, 1, Annual Reports:

	1874	1875	1876
Sales	\$1,479,719*	\$1,938,844	\$1,099,481
Land purchase and construction	862,509	2,113,437	1,144,471

* Includes bills receivable.

68. Compilation of sales from the *Newsletter* lists shows vacant lots produced 3% of sales revenue in 1873, 5.6% in 1874, 5.3% in 1876, 18.4% in 1877, and more thereafter. *Real Estate Circular*, May 1877, 2; Archives, "Transcript on Appeal," Case #7866, 22-23.

69. On 14 November, T.R.E.A. and Hollis jointly executed with the German Savings & Loan a \$150,000 mortgage of 61 land parcels each of which had already been mortgaged separately.

Hollis next "prevailed on the unsecured creditors to forbear immediate action" and to accept notes which the company could pay from rents and assets. These 18 creditors included the National Gold Bank, real estate agent and *Circular* publisher Thomas Magee, B. & J. S. Doe of the sash and door mill, lumber dealer Hansen & Ackerson, and plasterer Henry Helgoth. The notes amounted to some \$38,000. Yet another creditor, J. S. Polack, a realtor whom T.R.E.A. had never paid for a claim to the city's hospital lot in 1872, filed suit and attached property in May 1879.

Archives, "Mortgage," Exhibit D., Case #7866; "Affidavit of William Hale," filed 12 November 1881, Case #7866, 3; "Transcript," Case #7866, 51-52; *Judicial Gymnastics—Halsey's "Job"—Complete Report of the Meeting of Creditors of The Real Estate Associates . . .*, San Francisco, 1882,

and reinstated as president, he founded a new company, the Real Estate and Building Associates, incorporated in November 1879 with the same purposes as T.R.E.A. Capital stock worth \$500,000 was paid in, 99% by Hollis. The directors were Hollis's brother, two T.R.E.A. directors, two other friendly T.R.E.A. creditors, T.R.E.A.'s long-time Secretary Luis Emilio, and John B. Gonyeau, Superintendent of the Building Department. All of them, and all the T.R.E.A. directors, owed money to the original company, assets mentioned to the note-holders but never used to pay them. And of course the Building Associates' capital was really the assets of T.R.E.A., as it were, smuggled out to escape creditors. T.R.E.A. stockholders were urged to trade for Building Associates stock. On 1 March 1880 the T.R.E.A. directors resolved to sell a lot of property, including the T.R.E.A. Building, to Hollis for \$500. He, in turn, sold it to the Building Associates, which proceeded to do what business it could.⁷⁰

On 16 April 1880 the State Legislature entered the picture by passing an Insolvent Act. A number of legislators had been elected by the Workingmen's Party, inspired by T.R.E.A.'s former customer Denis Kearney. The Insolvent Act of 1880 was easy on individual debtors (that is, workers) and hard on corporations. If one of the latter went bankrupt, its assets would be sold and distributed to creditors, but it still could not be declared free of debt. Since no corporation would voluntarily go through this process, five or more creditors could petition a court to declare their debtor bankrupt.⁷¹

And so it happened to T.R.E.A. On 26 February 1881, five creditors petitioned Superior Court Judge Charles Halsey for the bankruptcy of The Associates. He appointed a receiver, attorney William Hale, who had sold the company many land claims, including the disputed land in *Voll vs. Hollis*. That very day Hale took possession of the T.R.E.A. Building. Within a week he changed the safe combination, fixed locks, and installed a 24-hour guard with bedding. Hollis made such difficulties about handing over rent and other assets that he was jailed for contempt of court early in May 1881, and he only got out two months later on *habeas corpus* petition to the State Supreme Court. The court wranglings and out-of-court evasions continued until the

passim; *Examiner*, 12 May 1879, 3; *Newsletter*, 11 January 1873, Postscript, 23.

70. Archives, "Affidavit of William Hale," Case #7866, 3; "Articles of Incorporation, Real Estate and Building Associates," Exhibit B, Case #7866; "Minutes of Board of Directors, Real Estate and Building Associates," Exhibit C, Case #7866; George H. Smith, reporter, "Ex Parte William Hollis," *Reports of Cases Determined in the Supreme Court of the State of California*, LIX, San Francisco, 1906, 410 (59 Cal 410).

71. *Statutes of California*, 1880 1, 82-94.

final appeal was turned down. In the squabbling over the remains, some creditors seemed to hope Hollis could recoup the losses, and some simply wanted what money was left.

While this farce was being played out, house construction in San Francisco was recovering from the depression. The *Directory* of April 1880 noticed the first signs: "An almost new town has within a year or so sprang up at the south-western outskirts of the Mission, between Twenty-fifth, Thirtieth, Guerrero and Sanchez streets. The buyers and builders were all people of small means."⁷² The 1880s and 1890s became San Francisco's great era for house construction. Over 10,000 of these residences remain, more than three times the number of survivors from the 1860s and 1870s. In the later two decades, 600 owner-builders have been identified, outstanding among them the Rountree Brothers, who bettered T.R.E.A.'s record, and Fernando Nelson, this city's most prolific 19th-century builder, responsible for over 4,000 houses.⁷³

72. Langley, *Directory*, 1880, 13.

73. Judith Lynch Waldhorn, "San Francisco's Victorian Heritage: The Carpenter-Builder Revealed," paper at the Northern California session, thirtieth annual meeting of the Society of Architectural Historians, Los

Amid all this activity The Real Estate Associates were forgotten. However this company had contributed a great deal to the development of San Francisco. It spread more than 1,000 houses in the first of "those endless rows . . . which ran in undulant streamers across the empty spaces of the Western Addition."⁷⁴ Its impression on the business community earned the flattery of imitation in name as well as in methods, by the Mechanics Real Estate Association, the Installment Homestead Union, and the San Francisco House and Loan Association.⁷⁵ It enabled many people of modest means to become homeowners in complete communities. Its model of the setback streetscape near public transportation with houses priced for the mass market was followed by most later builders in San Francisco. To this day, over 200 of The Associates' houses provide people with attractive, comfortable, practical living space.

Angeles, February 1977; Carol Orwell and J. L. Waldhorn, *A Gift to the Street*, San Francisco, 1976, 157-159; Kirker, *California's Architectural Frontier*, 103-110.

74. Baird, *Times Wondrous Changes*, 23-24.

75. *Chronicle*, 2 May 1877, 2; *Examiner*, 10 April 1877, 3; Langley, *Directory*, 1877, 12.

APPENDIX

THE REMAINING T.R.E.A. HOUSES

Houses	Original Sale in Newsletter		
BROADWAY		2536 ^a	16 December 1876, Postscript, 8; <i>San Francisco Directory</i> , 1882, 833
1787	11 December 1875, Postscript, 8	2548 ^a	16 December 1876, Postscript, 8; <i>San Francisco Directory</i> , 1882, 219
BUCHANAN STREET		2554 ^a	11 August 1877, Postscript, 2; <i>San Francisco Directory</i> , 1882, 388
1954-1956 ^a	3 October 1874, Postscript, 3	2557	20 April 1878, Postscript, 8
1958-1960 ^a	7 November 1874, 12	2565	20 April 1878, Postscript, 8
BUSH STREET		2573	25 May 1878, Postscript, 8
1710	11 December 1875, Postscript, 6	2577 ^a	20 October 1877, Postscript, 4
1712	20 November 1875, Postscript, 8	2578	3 March 1877, Postscript, 4
2115	16 January 1875, Postscript, 7	2591	19 January 1878, 15
2117	17 April 1875, Postscript, 2		
2119	30 January 1875, Postscript, 7	CLAY STREET	
2121	13 February 1875, Postscript, 7	2503	1 July 1871, 13
2123	13 February 1875, Postscript, 7	2524	6 March 1875, Postscript, 4
2125	20 February 1875, Postscript, 3	2530	13 March 1875, Postscript, 7
CALIFORNIA STREET		2536	27 March 1875, Postscript, 3
2129 ^a	8 August 1874, 7	2550 ^a	28 November 1874, Postscript, 4
2326 ^a	5 June 1875, Postscript, 7	2551-2555 ^a	28 September 1872, 7
2338	5 June 1875, Postscript, 7	2586	28 November 1874, Postscript, 4
2344	24 July 1875, Postscript, 7	2637	24 April 1875, Postscript, 6
2373 (villa)	30 September 1876, Postscript, 8	2643	28 August 1875, Postscript, 8
		2649	1 May 1875, Postscript, 3
		2655	3 July 1875, Postscript, 7
		2661	7 August 1875, Postscript, 8

^a = altered to the point of unrecognizability.

<i>Houses</i>	<i>Original Sale in Newsletter</i>		
2667	7 August 1875, Postscript, 8	HILL STREET	3 August 1878, 10, 16
2673	19 February 1876, Postscript, 4	18	10 August 1878, 15
		20	27 July 1878, 16
CLINTON PARK		22	15 June 1878, Postscript, 4
226	10 August 1878, 15	24	25 May 1878, Postscript, 8
232	2 November 1878, 16	26	6 July 1878, 14
236	7 September 1878, 16	28	31 August 1878, 16
255-257 ^a	20 April 1878, Postscript, 8	30	
DIVISADERO STREET		LAGUNA STREET	
1042	15 August 1874, Postscript, 2	1933 ^a	21 November 1874, Postscript, 4
EDDY STREET		LEXINGTON STREET	
1830	28 August 1875, Postscript, 8	317-319	18 November 1876, Postscript, 8
1832	7 August 1875, Postscript, 6	321-323 ^a	5 May 1877, Postscript, 4
1834	24 July 1875, Postscript, 7	325 ^a	12 January 1878, 15
		329	28 April 1877, Postscript, 4
FILLMORE STREET		330	8 April 1876, Postscript, 8
2211 ^a	<i>Real Estate Circular</i> , August 1871, 2	333-335	12 May 1877, Postscript, 4
2229 ^a	1 July 1871, 13	334	8 April 1876, Postscript, 8
		337-339	7 September 1878, 16
GOLDEN GATE AVENUE		338	
1503	15 January 1876, Postscript, 3	342	8 July 1876, Postscript, 4
1513	11 December 1875, Postscript, 7	346-348	21 April 1876, Postscript, 4
1515	15 January 1876, Postscript, 3	350	15 July 1876, Postscript, 8
1517	11 December 1875, Postscript, 6	352-354	14 October 1876, Postscript, 8
1519	6 November 1875, Postscript, 8	356-358	2 December 1876, Postscript, 8
1521	11 December 1875, Postscript, 7	362	
1523	11 December 1875, Postscript, 7	366-368	
1525	1 January 1876, 17	367	2 June 1877, Postscript, 4
1527	11 December 1876, Postscript, 7	370	22 July 1876, Postscript, 8
1529	11 December 1876, Postscript, 7	371-373 ^a	14 October 1876, Postscript, 8
1531	6 November 1875, Postscript, 8	375 ^a	14 October 1876, Postscript, 8
1609-1611 ^a	21 July 1877, Postscript, 4	376	14 October 1876, Postscript, 8
		380-382	5 August 1876, Postscript, 4
GOUGH STREET		381-383 ^a	14 October 1876, Postscript, 8
1701 ^a	23 October 1875, Postscript, 7	LIBERTY STREET	
1703	17 April 1875, Postscript, 2	19-21	2 March 1878, 14
1705	23 October 1875, Postscript, 7	23-25	19 October 1878, 16
1707 ^a	12 June 1875, Postscript, 3		
1709	19 June 1875, Postscript, 4	OCTAVIA STREET	
2312	11 December 1875, Postscript, 7	1703	27 December 1873, 7
GROVE STREET		O'FARRELL STREET	
745	7 February 1874, 7	1905-1907	9 March 1878, 14
755-757	6 December 1873, 7	ORBEN STREET	
759-761	13 December 1873, 7	45	21 November 1874, Postscript, 4
767-769	14 December 1872, Postscript, 3	PIERCE STREET	
771-773	14 December 1872, Postscript, 3	1335	26 April 1879, 13
777	10 August 1872, 7	1343-1345	18 January 1879, 17
GUERRERO STREET		1918	29 September 1877, Postscript, 4
120	15 March 1879, 17	1922	29 September 1877, Postscript, 4
122	30 November 1878, 15	1928	29 September 1877, Postscript, 4
126	16 November 1878, 16	1932	17 November 1877, Postscript, 4
		2126 ^a	6 November 1875, Postscript, 8
HAMPSHIRE STREET		PINE STREET	
1216	10 November 1877, Postscript, 4	1836	12 June 1875, Postscript, 3
1218	16 December 1876, Postscript, 8	1848	5 June 1875, Postscript, 7
		2018-2020	26 December 1874, Postscript, 8
		2022	26 December 1874, Postscript, 8

^a = questionable whether built by T.R.E.A.

<i>Houses</i>	<i>Original Sale in Newsletter</i>	<i>2251^a</i>	<i>Real Estate Circular, August 1874, 2</i>
2062-2064	19 December 1874, Postscript, 4	SUTTER STREET	<i>Real Estate Circular, December 1874, 2</i>
2428	16 March 1878, Postscript, 8	1527	2 January 1875, Postscript, 4
2430	9 November 1878, 17	1529 ^a	15 May 1875, Postscript, 3
2432 ^a	<i>Real Estate Circular</i> , November 1878, 2	1689	"Cash Book," 2 March 1880
2434	23 March 1878, 15	1809	15 May 1880, 16
SACRAMENTO STREET		1811	"Cash Book," 20 March 1880
2519	5 June 1875, Postscript, 7	1825	28 August 1875, Postscript, 8
2521	7 August 1875, Postscript, 6	1942	<i>Real Estate Circular</i> , March 1875, 2
2530 ^a	1 July 1871, 13	1948	15 December 1877, 15
2538-2540 ^a	1 July 1871, 13	2614	13 October 1877, Postscript, 8
2552-2554 ^a	1 July 1871, 13	2616	1 December 1877, 14
2564	10 June 1871, 13	2618	13 October 1877, Postscript, 8
2604 ^a	21 March or 16 May 1874, 7	2624	26 January 1878, 14
2606 ^a	21 March or 16 May 1874, 7	2626 ^{qa}	12 May 1877, Postscript, 4
2608	16 January 1875, Postscript, 7	2630 ^{qa}	
2616	16 January 1875, Postscript, 7	TWENTIETH STREET	
2618	12 December 1874, Postscript, 4	3517 ^a	6 November 1875, Postscript, 8
SAN CARLOS STREET		3549-3551	16 December 1876, Postscript, 8
236	6 February 1875, Postscript, 7	3555 ^a	8 April 1876, Postscript, 8
274	30 January 1875, Postscript, 7	3561-3563 ^q	6 May 1876, Postscript, 8
317 ^a	12 February 1876, Postscript, 8	TWENTY-FIRST STREET	
320 ^a	5 February 1876, Postscript, 8	3238 ^a	8 July 1876, Postscript, 4
321	19 February 1876, Postscript, 4	3330	5 January 1878, Postscript, 4
324	9 December 1876, Postscript, 8	3334	16 February 1878, 14
325	12 February 1876, Postscript, 8	VALENCIA STREET	
327-329 ^a	12 February 1876, Postscript, 8	929	29 April 1876, Postscript, 8
328-330 ^{qa}	12 February 1876, Postscript, 8	933	20 May 1876, Postscript, 4
333	12 February 1876, Postscript, 8	937-939 ^a	29 April 1876, Postscript, 8
334	5 February 1876, Postscript, 8	945	1 January 1876, 18
337-339 ^a	19 February 1876, Postscript, 4	953-955	10 June 1876, Postscript, 8
342-344 ^{qa}	26 February 1876, Postscript, 4	959-961 ^a	2 September 1876, Postscript, 7
343	1 July 1876, Postscript, 4	1057	3 August 1878, 16
345-347 ^a	1 July 1876, Postscript, 4	WASHINGTON STREET	
346-348 ^{qa}	26 February 1876, Postscript, 4	2400 ^a	7 December 1878, 16; 13 December 1879, 15
350		2432 ^a	23 November 1878, 16; 1 February 1879, 28
351	15 July 1876, Postscript, 8	2440 ^a	23 November 1878, 16; 21 December 1879, 28
354-356 ^a	27 January 1877, Postscript, 4	2566	2 November 1878, 16
358-360	30 December 1876, Postscript, 8	2572	15 June 1878, Postscript, 4
362-364 ^a	30 December 1876, Postscript, 8	WEBSTER STREET	
366-368	16 December 1876, Postscript, 8	2311	12 October 1878, 17
370-372	2 December 1876, Postscript, 8	2315	15 February 1879, 16
376 ^a	18 November 1876, Postscript, 8	2317	16 November 1878, 16
SAN JOSE AVENUE		2319	<i>Examiner</i> , 14 January 1879, 3
271 (villa)	12 May 1877, Postscript, 4	2321	17 May 1879, 17
279 (villa) ^a	23 September 1876, Postscript, 8	YORK STREET	
STEINER STREET		1209-1211	22 January 1876, Postscript, 7
2204	9 August 1873, 7	1217	5 February 1876, Postscript, 8
2206	2 August 1873, 7	1219	22 April 1876, Postscript, 8
2208	7 June or 20 September 1873, 7	1221	12 August 1876, Postscript, 8
2231	7 or 21 March 1874, 7	1227	9 September 1876, Postscript, 8
2237 ^a	7 or 21 March 1874, 7	1229	9 November 1878, 17
2242	15 November 1873, 7	1231 ^a	2 December 1876, Postscript, 8
2243 ^a	1 August 1874, Postscript, 2		
2244	10 January 1874, 7		